

Citadel Journal Issue 6

WHEN THE DEAD SAIL THE SEAS

Undead Fleets



MAN O' WAR[®]

WHEN THE DEAD SAIL THE SEAS

BY JOURNAL READERS (Yes, you lot out there)

Okay! Okay! Give us a break! We've had loads of letters with ideas for Undead Fleets in Man O' War, nine people asked me about Undead at the Golden Demon Awards, and many more of you have written in with questions about when are they going to be released, what will they have in them, and so on. We've bowed to the pressure and taken all the best bits and compiled this article. Perhaps you might recognise an idea of yours.

From the tomb city of Zandri and hidden refuges within the Dragonback Mountains, the fleets of the Tomb Kings, Necromancers and Liches of the world set forth to enslave the living. From the Sour Sea on the borders of Nagash's realm, huge waterborne hosts drift silently out to raid the convoys of the Empire and Bretonnia.

Rather than relying on the vagaries of the wind, Undead fleets use the power of their Liches and Necromancers to move them silently through the raging seas. Black clouds of bats gather over the assembled vessels, blotting out the sun and swooping down on the enemy ships with bowel-loosening shrieks.

Accompanying the Floating Necropolises and Ghostships are the ranks of Deathships and Skullrammers. Above fly the hideous Zombie Dragons, whose pestilential breath corrupts the flesh and burns the skin. Soaring high in the air are the strange Carrion, drawn out of the Chaos Wastes by the fleet's controller and set to dive down on the enemy crews, attacking with beak, claw and wraith-like scythe.

The ships of the Undead fleet are crewed by various creatures, of which skeletons form the bulk. Zombies are employed where speed and alertness in boarding actions is unnecessary, while the flagships of the fleet have a contingent of Wights to lead the attack and storm over the enemy's bulwarks, wielding huge blades that cut men down like ripe corn.



GAME RULES

Choosing an Undead Fleet

The first thing you must decide upon when choosing your Undead fleet is who the Admiral is. It may be a Tomb King, Liche or Necromancer. The fleet must have a spell caster to keep the fleet moving and afloat, and Necromancers and Liches fulfil this role too. A Tomb King must purchase a Wizard as normal, who represents a less skilled Necromancer than those who can command entire fleets. Fleets led by a Liche or Necromancer may not have an additional Wizard. Pay the points indicated on the Fleet list for these characters.

Next you must purchase the rest of your fleet, within the restrictions given on the Fleet List.



Undead Crews

Undead crews can be formed from Zombies, Skeletons or Wights, or any mixture. Each Admiral allows you a number of Crew Points for every 500 points or part that the fleet is worth, which you use to summon your crew. Each Crew counter you purchase costs a certain number of Crew points. You may assign any number of Crew counters to a ship, up to the maximum shown on the ship's template. These can be of any type you have purchased. Obviously a ship which begins with no crew counts as abandoned from the start.

When you stack the crew on the ship's template, they are stacked in 'order of attack', with the counter on the top of the stack said to be 'leading the attack'. In boarding actions it is the boarding bonus (see later) of the counter that is leading the attack that is counted, and it is this counter that is killed if the Undead lose the boarding action. If the crew take casualties in some other fashion, determine which crew are lost by rolling a dice, selecting a counter at random, or some similar method.

BOARDING BONUS TABLE

Crew Type	Bonus to roll if leading the attack	Crew Points
Zombies	-1	1
Skeletons	0	2
Wights	+1	3

UNDEAD MAGIC USERS

The Wizard of the fleet (or the Liche/ Necromancer Admiral) uses the following rules, and has the casting bonuses indicated on the Necromantic Magic Users table at the end of this article. The Wizard counts as an ordinary Wizard for all purposes, and also confers the additional liabilities and benefits listed below.

As long as the Wizard is still alive the ships may move and fight normally, if he dies or is captured the ships lose the binding magic and collapse into the sea. When he dies all ships of the line immediately take D6 below the waterline hits, with no saving throw allowed. Battle Honours are awarded as usual.

Once per turn, at any time in the Battle Phase, a *Liche* or *Necromancer* may perform one of the following actions:

1. Allow a single Undead ship within 6" to move again, though it may not fire or strat a boarding action,
2. Allow a single Undead ship within 6" to fire all of its weapons again,
3. Allow a single Undead ship within 6" to roll an extra 1D6 while boarding and add the result to its score.

Undead Wizards may use normal Colleges of Magic spells, but do not belong to a single college and so do not get the benefits usually obtained by a Wizard using spells of his own college.

THE SHIPS OF THE DAMNED

The Undead Fleet has 4 types of ship; the Floating Necropolis, the Ghostship, the Skullrammer and the Deathship.

Screaming Skull Catapults

Most Undead ships carry batteries of Screaming Skull Catapults which follow these rules. The Screaming Skull Catapults may not be fired at short range as their high trajectory does not allow them be aimed at targets close to the vessel. The Screaming Skull Catapults must be targetted at a High location if the target ship has High and Low locations, and if they successfully hit the target location has a no modifier to its saving throw.

If the first location fails its saving throw and takes damage, the ammunition continues to plummet downwards, crashing through lower decks. A location directly beneath the first is hit (roll between possible choices) suffers a hit with a +1 saving throw modifier. If this is also damaged it continues downwards again, with subsequent hits having a +2, +3 and +4 saving throw modifier as its descent is slowed. It stops its fall as soon as a location passes its saving throw and doesn't get damaged.

Roll 1D6 at the end of the Battle Phase for a ship that has taken damage from a Screaming Skull Catapult during that turn, on a roll of 1 it loses 1 Crew counter as they panic and hide, or abandon ship.

FLOATING NECROPOLISES

The Floating Necropolis is a huge vessel, more akin to a fortification than a ship. It is similar to the Black Arks of the Dark Elves, and has considerable armour and weapons.

The Necropolis has vast banks of Screaming Skull Catapults, and also acts as a vortex for magical energy. A Wizard which ends the turn on a Floating Necropolis may hold one extra card than normally allowed. If he has more cards than normally allowed and is moved from the Floating Necropolis then he must discard one of his choice immediately.



A Necropolis is surrounded by an aura of magic, and allows the crew to survive and be resurrected from normally fatal damage. Whenever the Necropolis loses a crew, for whatever reason, it is saved from destruction on a D6 roll of 5 or 6, do not remove the counter from the ship's template.

A Floating Necropolis is moved by magical means, which pays no heed to currents or wind. These Undead ships may move and turn with no restriction. However, damage to the ship's hull fractures the magical field sustaining the ship, causing it to slow down as indicated on the ship's template.

GHOSTSHIPS

Ghostships are large Undead vessels, their huge bone structures shimmering with the magical energy which sustains them. They glide soundlessly through the waves, their rows of Screaming Skull Catapults pointing menacingly over the bulwarks.

Because of their slightly insubstantial nature, any vessel which attempts to board or attack the Ghostship in any way must roll a D6 first. On a roll of 1 they fail to contact the ship with their attack, and gaze in horror as cannonballs or bolts pass straight through. They may not do anything except defend themselves in boarding actions for the remainder of the turn. This does not apply to magical attacks.

DEATHSHIPS

Deathships are small vessels that form the bulk of any Undead fleet. Their speed allows them to manoeuvre easily, while their battery of Screaming Skull Catapults is a threat to any ship. The Deathship is armed with a single Screaming Skull Catapult battery that fires to the front.

SKULLRAMMER

The Skullrammer is a highly specialised vessel, on its prow is mounted a wicked, barbed blade that smashes through opposing ships' hulls with unearthly ease. When it strikes bolts of magical lightning arc out over the opposing vessel, causing even more damage and starting fires.

The Skullrammer glides along pushed by magical energy, and so does not rely on the wind to move it. However it is still shaped like a ship and must use the turning template as normal.

The Skullrammer may make a ram attack as detailed in the Man O' War rulebook. In addition, the target ship suffers an additional number of hits on random locations (if the ship has High and Low locations the Lightning bolts affect only Low locations). Roll 1D6 to find out how many lightning bolts hit the other ship:

D6 roll	Number of hits
1-2	1
3-5	2
6	3



Roll a dice for each lightning bolt to determine which location it hits. If you roll a 1 it has missed totally, any other roll which would normally indicate a miss should be re-rolled until a hit or a 1 is scored. The lightning bolts have no saving throw modifier, and will cause a Blaze if the ship fails its saving throw. The lightning bolts cannot cause critical hits.

FLYERS

An Undead fleet may purchase Carrion and Zombie Dragons as flyers. These follow all of the normal rules for flyers, and any special rules are detailed in the following descriptions.

CARRION

Carrion are huge winged beasts from the Chaos Wastes, called forth from their hunting grounds by the intense magic that surrounds an Undead fleet. On their back sits a small Wraith-like figure, which feeds off the escaping life force of the dying.

Points Cost	100 per squadron of 3
Move Rate	18"
Wounds	2
Saving Throw	6
Battle Honours	1 each

Special Attack

The Carrion may only use its special attack during boarding actions and so is covered in the next section.

Boarding Actions

The Carrion gets 1 dice +2 in boarding actions and close combat, as it has 2 wounds.

When the Carrion wins a round of combat it gains a +1 modifier to its boarding or combat roll in the next round. This is cumulative, and so if it wins two rounds in a row it gains +2, and so on. If it is beaten it gains no bonus until it wins another round of combat. This only applies to each boarding action or close combat individually, and so the Carrion never has a bonus in the first round of a new boarding action or close combat.

ZOMBIE DRAGONS

The Zombie Dragon is a corrupted and decayed version of the mighty beasts of the sky. Its skin is torn, its flesh leprous and its wings nothing but scrawny tatters held onto exposed bone and sinew. However, the magic of an Undead fleet allows it to fly once again.

Points Cost	75 each
Move Rate	15"
Wounds	4
Saving Throw	4, 5 or 6
Battle Honours	3 each

Special Attack

A Zombie Dragon can blast at its foes with a breath of pestilence which rots flesh and rusts weapons and armour. The breath will hit on a roll of 5 or 6 and if successful kills one Crew counter.

Boarding Actions

A Zombie Dragon has four wounds and therefore gets 1 dice +4 in boarding actions and close combats.

ANTI-FLYER WEAPONS

Undead vessels can carry a detachment of Skeleton Archers to fire at incoming flyers. They have a range of 3" and roll 4 dice. A regiment of Skeleton Archers costs 25 points as normal



UNDEAD FLEET

An Undead Fleet may consist of the following:

1 Admiral:

You must choose an Admiral for your fleet.

Type	Cost	Battle Honours*	Crew Points/500 points
Liche	300	12	10
Necromancer	250	11	8
Tomb King	50	7	9

* Including Battle Honours for being Admiral.

1 Wizard

If you have a Tomb King for an Admiral you must also purchase a Wizard. You may not purchase a Wizard if you have a Liche or Necromancer as your Admiral.

Type	Cost
Wizard Champion	50
High Wizard Champion	75
Master Wizard	100
High Master Wizard	125
Wizard Lord	150
High Wizard Lord	175
Grand Wizard Lord	200

Men O' War 1+

Your Fleet must include one Floating Necropolis.

Cost: 250 points.

You may have one Ghostship for every Ship of the Line squadron.

Cost: 150 points.

Ship of the Line Squadrons 1+

You must have at least one Ship of the Line squadron.

Skullrammers

Cost: 250 points per squadron of three.

Deathships

Cost: 150 points per squadron of three.

Flyers and Anti-flyer Weapons 0+

You may include one or more squadrons of three Carrion.

Cost: 100 points per squadron.

You may include one or more Zombie Dragons.

Cost: 75 points each.

You may buy up to one detachment of Skeleton Archers for each Man O' War in the fleet.

Cost: 25 points each.

Man O' War cards

1st card with admiral, subsequent cards at 25 points each.

NECROMANTIC MAGIC USERS

Sorcerer	Number of Spell cards	Casting/dispel bonus*
Liche	8	+1
Necromancer	8	+1
Wizard Champion	2	0
High Wizard Champion	3	0
Master Wizard	4	0
High Master Wizard	5	0
Wizard Lord	6	0
High Wizard Lord	7	0
Grand Wizard Lord	8	+1**

*A Necromantic Magic User's bonus applies to all colleges of magic.

** Grand Wizard Lords may re-roll any type of spell that they fail to cast or dispel.

The Undead Sorcerers use the expanded rules for Man O' War wizards, detailed on page 37 of White Dwarf 164.



UNDEAD FLEET

FLOATING NECROPOLIS

MAXIMUM CREW: 8

MOVE

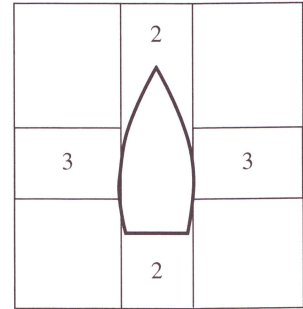
Magic: 6". The ship may turn and change its facing without restriction.

WEAPONS

2 Screaming Skull Catapults firing ahead. 2 Screaming Skull Catapults firing behind. 3 Screaming Skull Catapults broadside.

SPECIAL RULES

Necromantic Magic Users gain an extra Spell card while on board. Killed Crew regenerate and are not removed on a roll of 5 or 6, rolled for each counter.



GHOSTSHIP

MAXIMUM CREW: 5

MOVE

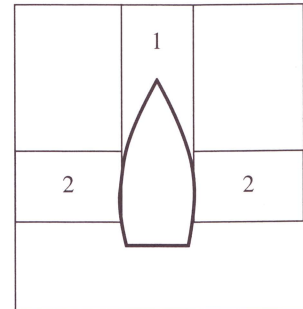
Sail: 6"

WEAPONS

1 Screaming Skull Catapult firing ahead. 2 Screaming Skull Catapults broadside.

SPECIAL RULES

Any attempts to board, ram or shoot at a Ghostship are automatically unsuccessful on a roll of a 1, causing the attacking ship to do nothing else for the remainder of the turn.



SKULLRAMMERS

MAXIMUM CREW: 3

MOVE

Magic: 6". The ship must turn and move normally.

WEAPONS

No ranged weapons.

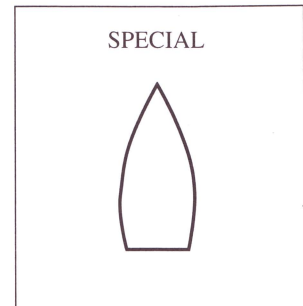
SPECIAL RULES

May ram. To make a ram, ship must move at least 3" in a straight line before contacting the target vessel. Target must make a below the waterline saving throw or suffer damage as shown by a roll of a dice on the following table:

1-2	1 point of below the waterline damage
3-4	2 points of below the waterline damage
5-6	3 points of below the waterline damage

In addition, the target vessel also suffers a number of hits to randomly determined Low locations. Roll a dice and consult the following chart to see how many are affected. Locations that suffer a hit must make an unmodified saving throw or have a Blaze marker placed on it.

1-2	1 Low location hit.
3-5	2 Low locations hit.
6	3 Low locations hit.



DEATHSHIPS

MAXIMUM CREW: 3

MOVE

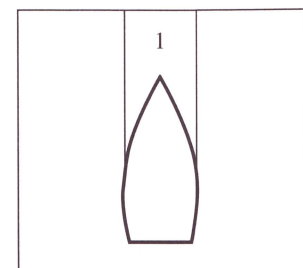
Sail: 6"

WEAPONS

1 Screaming Skull catapult battery firing ahead.

SPECIAL RULES

None



UNDEAD

FLOATING NECROPOLIS

MAN O' WAR

MAX.
CREW
8

HIGH		LOW			
4	SKULL DECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Fore Screaming Skull battery lost	5	TOWERS Save 4, 5 or 6	6	REAR TOWERS Save 4, 5 or 6 Aft Screaming Skull battery lost
2	FOREDECK Save 3, 4, 5 or 6 Fore Screaming Skull battery lost	3	MAIN DECK Save 3, 4, 5 or 6 Each hit destroys one broadside Screaming Skull battery		
4	BASTION Save 4, 5 or 6	5	KEEP Save 3, 4, 5 or 6 Broadside Screaming Skull battery lost	6	AFT CASTLE Save 4, 5 or 6 Aft Screaming Skull battery lost
BELOW WATERLINE Save 4, 5 or 6 First six hits each reduce the ship's speed by 1" Seventh hit sinks ship					
-1" MOVE	-1" MOVE	-1" MOVE	-1" MOVE	-1" MOVE	SINKS

MAGIC 6" (6")

BATTLE HONOURS: 12

NAME:

UNDEAD GHOSTSHIP

**MAX.
CREW
5**

MAN O' WAR

4	FOREMAST Save 5 or 6 -2" move No critical hits	5, 6	MAIN MAST Save 5 or 6 Each hit reduces move by 2". No critical hits	HIGH		
	FOREDECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Lose one random Crew counter	3	AFTDECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Broadside Screaming Skull battery lost			
4	BOWS Save 4, 5 or 6 Fore Screaming Skull battery lost	5	MAIN DECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Broadside Screaming Skull battery lost	6	STERN Save 4, 5 or 6	LOW
BELOW THE WATERLINE Save 4, 5 or 6 First three hits have no effect Fourth hit sinks ship						

SAIL 6"

BATTLE HONOURS 5

Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton
Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton
Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton
Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton
Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie
Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Liche	Necro mancer	Tomb King	Necro mantic	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie

	UNDEAD SKULLRAMMER			MAX. CREW 3	
SHIP OF THE LINE					
RAM Save 3, 4, 5 or 6 1st hit, no effect. 2nd hit, ram destroyed	3	TOWERS Save 4, 5 or 6 -2" Movement	4	STERN Save 4, 5 or 6 -2" movement	5
		HULL Save 4, 5 or 6 -2" Movement	6		
NO EFFECT SINKS BELOW THE WATERLINE Save 5 or 6 First hit has no effect, second hit sinks ship					
MAGIC 6" (6")			BATTLE HONOURS 2		

	UNDEAD DEATHSHIP			MAX. CREW 3	
SHIP OF THE LINE					
BOWS Save 4, 5 or 6 Screaming Skull battery lost	3	MAST Save 4, 5 or 6 Mast lost, cannot move. No criticals.	4	STERN Save 4, 5 or 6	5
		HULL Save 4, 5 or 6	6		
NO EFFECT SINKS BELOW THE WATERLINE Save 5 or 6 First hit has no effect, second hit sinks ship					
SAIL 6"			BATTLE HONOURS 2		

1

UNDEAD

CARRION

POINTS COST: 100 for 3 BATTLE HONOURS: 1

4,5,6

CARRION

Save 5 or 6

Each hit causes 1 Wound. No criticals.

6

RIDER

Save 4, 5 or 6

If rider is killed remove model from play

4,5

DRAGON

Save 4, 5 or 6

Each hit to this location causes 1 Wound. No criticals.

CLOSE COMBAT

Gets a +2 modifier as it has 2 wounds. When the Carrion successfully wins a round of combat it gains a +1 modifier to its boarding or combat roll in the next round. This is cumulative.

WOUND TRACK

NO EFFECT

DEAD

MOVE: 18"

1

UNDEAD

ZOMBIE DRAGON

POINTS COST: 75 BATTLE HONOURS: 3

6

ATTACKS

Makes 1 dice breath attack, hitting on a roll of 5 or 6 and if successful killing one Crew counter.

4,5

CLOSE COMBAT

Gets a +4 modifier as it has 4 wounds.

WOUND TRACK

NO EFFECT

NO EFFECT

NO EFFECT

DEAD

MOVE: 15"

Wight
Skeleton
Skeleton
Zombie
Zombie
Zombie

Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight	Wight
Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton	Skeleton
Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie	Zombie

Wight
Skeleton
Skeleton
Zombie
Zombie
Zombie

MAN O'WAR

UNDEAD PLAYSHEET

THE ADMIRAL

You must choose one of the following to be your fleet's Admiral. Each Admiral allows you a certain number of Crew points for every 500 points (or part) that the total fleet is worth. Each ship has a maximum Crew allowance, and the cost of the different types of Crew is detailed below.

Admiral	Cost	Battle Honours*	Crew points/500 points
Liche	300	12	10
Necromancer	250	11	8
Tomb King	50	7	9

* Including Battle Honours for being Admiral.

Crew type	Bonus to roll if leading the attack	Crew points
Zombies	-1	1
Skeletons	0	2
Wights	+1	3

NECROMANCY

The Wizard of the fleet (or the Liche/ Necromancer Admiral) uses the following rules. The Wizard counts as an ordinary Wizard for all purposes, and also confers the additional liabilities and benefits listed below.

As long as the Wizard is still alive the ships may move and fight normally, if he dies or is captured the ships lose the binding magic and collapse into the sea. When he dies all ships of the line immediately take D6 below the waterline hits, with no saving throw allowed. Battle Honours are awarded as usual.

Once per turn, at any time in the Battle Phase, the Wizard confers the following bonus to the fleet. A single ship within 6" of him (including the ship he is on) may do one of the following; move immediately, fire all its weapons immediately or roll an extra D6 in a single round of a boarding action.

FLOATING NECROPOLIS

MAXIMUM CREW: 8

MOVE

Magic: 6". The ship may turn and change its facing without restriction.

WEAPONS

2 Screaming Skulls firing ahead. 2 Screaming Skull Catapults firing behind. 3 Screaming Skull Catapults broadside.

SPECIAL RULES

Necromancers and liches gain an extra Spell card while on board. Killed Crew can regenerate. If a crew is killed roll a D6. On a roll of a 5 or 6 they have regenerated and are not removed.

GHOSTSHIP

MAXIMUM CREW: 5

MOVE

Sail: 6"

WEAPONS

1 Screaming Skull Catapult firing ahead. 2 Screaming Skull Catapults broadside.

SPECIAL RULES

If an enemy model wishes to board, ram or shoot at a Ghostship, then they must roll a D6. On a roll of a 1 they are automatically unsuccessful causing the attacking model to do nothing else for the remainder of the turn. Any other result means the attack goes ahead as normal.

SKULLRAMMERS

MAXIMUM CREW: 3

MOVE

Magic: 6". The ship must turn and move normally.

WEAPONS

No ranged weapons.

SPECIAL RULES

May ram. To make a ram, ship must move at least 3" in a straight line before contacting the target vessel. Target must make a below the waterline saving throw or suffer damage as shown by a roll of a dice on the following table:

1-2	1 point of below the waterline damage
3-4	2 points of below the waterline damage
5-6	3 points of below the waterline damage

In addition, the target vessel also suffers a number of hits to randomly determined Low locations. Roll a dice and consult the following chart to see how many are affected. Locations that suffer a hit must make an unmodified saving throw or have a Blaze marker placed on it.

1-2	1 Low location hit.
3-5	2 Low locations hit.
6	3 Low locations hit.

DEATHSHIPS

MAXIMUM CREW: 3

MOVE

Sail: 6"

WEAPONS

1 Screaming Skull catapult battery firing ahead.

SPECIAL RULES

None